

Sunny and the Sleepy Echidna

Sonny's Cozy Quokka Bedtime Tales — Book 8



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The moon was soft. The earth was warm and still.
Sunny walked beneath the wattle trees.



She heard a snuffle, low and slow and near,
a shuffle-shuffle through the fallen leaves.



A little echidna, round and covered soft
in cream-and-brown spines, snuffling the ground.



Its long thin snout went poking here and there,
looking for its supper, slow and calm.



"Hello," said Sunny. "Aren't you off to bed?"
"Soon," it snuffled. "Just one more little snack."



It waddled slowly, spines all soft with dusk,
not in any hurry, calm and sure.



"I never rush," the echidna gently said.
"The night is long. There's time enough to rest."

A watercolor illustration of a small, fluffy brown squirrel sitting in a field of yellow flowers under a starry night sky with a crescent moon. The squirrel is looking up and to the right with a gentle expression. The background is a deep blue night sky filled with stars and a crescent moon. The foreground is filled with yellow flowers and green leaves.

So Sunny slowed her breathing, soft and deep,
and felt the calm of the unhurried night.



The stars came out. The wattle flowers glowed.
The bush was warm and golden in the dark.



The echidna curled into a cosy ball
and tucked itself beneath a bank of moss.



Sunny found a hollow, soft and warm,
and nestled down among the fallen leaves.



The night was slow. There was no need to hurry.
Everything was calm and safe and still.



Her eyes grew heavy, slow as drifting clouds.
One slow blink... then another... then no more.



And Sunny slept, unhurried as the echidna,
gentle dreams beneath the quiet stars.



Goodnight, Sunny. Goodnight, slow echidna.
Goodnight, sleepy bush. Goodnight, little one.

The End

Sweet dreams, little one.

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